CPU + MOTHERBOARD

Intel Core Ultra 5 250K Plus + Gigabyte B860 Eagle WiFi6E

The Core Ultra 5 250K Plus brings 6 performance cores and 12 efficient cores, with boosts up to 5.3GHz, and it costs far less than its core count suggests. Gigabyte's B860 Eagle





WiFi6E is a no-nonsense LGA1851 board with DDR5 support, a PCIe 5.0 graphics slot and Wi-Fi 6E. The combo works because neither part carries a premium you will not use. The B860 chipset handles this unlocked chip without drama. Use it for 1080p and 1440p gaming, streaming, and everyday editing in Premiere or DaVinci.

AMD Ryzen 5 7600X + Gigabyte X670 Aorus Elite AX

The Ryzen 5 7600X packs six Zen 4 cores and 12 threads, with boosts up to 5.3GHz, and its single-thread speed still keeps games snappy. Gigabyte's X670 Aorus Elite AX is a full ATX AM5 board with DDR5, PCIe 5.0 support and Wi-Fi 6E. The combo works because the board is more capable than the chip needs, which gives you headroom. When AMD's faster Ryzen processors drop in price, you can swap one into the same socket and keep the board, memory and cooler. Use it for 1440p gaming, school or college projects, light photo editing and everyday multitasking.

Intel Core Ultra 9 285K + ASRock Z890 Pro RS WiFi

The Core Ultra 9 285K is Intel's Arrow Lake flagship, with 8 performance cores, 16 efficient cores and boosts up to 5.7GHz. ASRock's Z890 Pro RS WiFi is a Z-series board, so it unlocks CPU overclocking and faster DDR5 memory tuning, and it adds built-in wireless. The combo works because the 285K needs a board with strong power delivery and a full feature set, and Z890 supplies both. Productivity is where this pairing shines. Think 4K videos, 3D rendering, code compiles, and heavy multitasking with dozens of browser tabs open. Gaming is excellent, though AMD's X3D chips lead on FPS for pure gamers.

AMD Ryzen 9 9950X3D2 + MSI MPG X870I Edge Ti Evo WiFi7

The Ryzen 9 9950X3D2 stacks 3D V-Cache on both chiplets, giving you 16 cores, 32 threads and 192MB of L3 cache. MSI's MPG X870I Edge Ti Evo WiFi7 is an AM5 mini-ITX board with USB4, so the whole platform fits a compact case. The combo works because the board packs flagship features into a small footprint, while the chip delivers high performance. Use it for 4K gaming, simulation titles that love cache, and creator work like rendering and compiling. Pick a capable cooler and a roomy case with some real airflow.





AMD Ryzen 7 8700G + Asus B650M-AYW WiFi

The Ryzen 7 8700G has 8 Zen 4 cores, 16 threads and a Radeon 780M integrated GPU, so it works as both CPU and starter graphics. Asus's B650M-AYW WiFi is a compact micro-ATX AM5 board with DDR5 and Wi-Fi, which keeps cost and case size down. The combo works because you skip the graphics card at first and still get a usable machine. Use it for esports titles at 1080p, home office work, media streaming and light editing, or as a compact living room PC.